

October 22, 2025

Employee Name: CHRISTOPHE FOWLER
Employer Name: Centene Corporation
Correspondence Type: Intermittent Leave Denial
Leave ID No.: 17960426

Purpose of Letter

We are writing to inform you that your leave under the Family & Medical Leave Act (FMLA) request for a leave of absence due to your own medical condition has been denied because you did not submit and/or fully complete the required documents for your leave.

If you are a part-time employee who has worked at least 1250 hours in the past 12 months and believe you are eligible for benefits, please contact Centene to determine your eligibility for leave.

Please contact Leave Services if you have any questions.

Sincerely,

Lincoln Financial Leave Services Team
Office Phone: (800) 213-7649
Office Fax: (603) 334-0380
Email: centene@lfg.com

Attachments: FMLA Rights
Custom Form 01



24/7 Updates

Visit My Lincoln Portal[®] from your computer or mobile device at <https://www.lincolnfinancial.com> to:

- Report an absence
- Track the status of a claim or leave
- View payment information
- View leave entitlements, time available, used, and remaining
- Access contact information
- Download forms and educational resources
- Report your return to work

First-time users: Register by creating a user login and password using company code: Centene



Receive Letters Sooner

Get letters, forms, and other important information by email! Send your paperless request to centene@lfg.com with your name and leave ID to sign up!



Contact Us

By Email: centene@lfg.com

By Phone: (800) 213-7649

By Fax: (603) 334-0380

Write us:
The Lincoln National Life Insurance Company
Leave Services
P.O. Box 2578
Omaha, NE 68103-2578

Your Employee Rights Under the Family and Medical Leave Act

What is FMLA leave?

The Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) is a federal law that provides eligible employees with **job-protected leave** for qualifying family and medical reasons. The U.S. Department of Labor's Wage and Hour Division (WHD) enforces the FMLA for most employees.

Eligible employees can take **up to 12 workweeks** of FMLA leave in a 12-month period for:

- The birth, adoption or foster placement of a child with you,
- Your serious mental or physical health condition that makes you unable to work,
- To care for your spouse, child or parent with a serious mental or physical health condition, and
- Certain qualifying reasons related to the foreign deployment of your spouse, child or parent who is a military servicemember.

An eligible employee who is the spouse, child, parent or next of kin of a covered servicemember with a serious injury or illness **may take up to 26 workweeks** of FMLA leave in a single 12-month period to care for the servicemember.

You have the right to use FMLA leave in **one block of time**. When it is medically necessary or otherwise permitted, you may take FMLA leave **intermittently in separate blocks of time, or on a reduced schedule** by working less hours each day or week. Read Fact Sheet #28M(c) for more information.

FMLA leave is **not paid leave**, but you may choose, or be required by your employer, to use any employer-provided paid leave if your employer's paid leave policy covers the reason for which you need FMLA leave.

Am I eligible to take FMLA leave?

You are an **eligible employee** if **all** of the following apply:

- You work for a covered employer,
- You have worked for your employer at least 12 months,
- You have at least 1,250 hours of service for your employer during the 12 months before your leave, and
- Your employer has at least 50 employees within 75 miles of your work location.

Airline flight crew employees have different "hours of service" requirements.

You work for a **covered employer** if **one** of the following applies:

- You work for a private employer that had at least 50 employees during at least 20 workweeks in the current or previous calendar year,
- You work for an elementary or public or private secondary school, or
- You work for a public agency, such as a local, state or federal government agency. Most federal employees are covered by Title II of the FMLA, administered by the Office of Personnel Management.

How do I request FMLA leave?

Generally, to request FMLA leave you **must**:

- Follow your employer's normal policies for requesting leave,
- Give notice at least 30 days before your need for FMLA leave, or
- If advance notice is not possible, give notice as soon as possible.

You **do not have to share a medical diagnosis** but must provide enough information to your employer so they can determine whether the leave qualifies for FMLA protection. You **must also inform your employer if FMLA leave was previously taken** or approved for the same reason when requesting additional leave.

Your employer **may request certification** from a health care provider to verify medical leave and may request certification of a qualifying exigency.

The FMLA does not affect any federal or state law prohibiting discrimination or supersede any state or local law or collective bargaining agreement that provides greater family or medical leave rights.

State employees may be subject to certain limitations in pursuit of direct lawsuits regarding leave for their own serious health conditions. Most federal and certain congressional employees are also covered by the law but are subject to the jurisdiction of the U.S. Office of Personnel Management or Congress.

What does my employer need to do?

If you are eligible for FMLA leave, your employer **must**:

- Allow you to take job-protected time off work for a qualifying reason,
- Continue your group health plan coverage while you are on leave on the same basis as if you had not taken leave, and
- Allow you to return to the same job, or a virtually identical job with the same pay, benefits and other working conditions, including shift and location, at the end of your leave.

Your employer **cannot interfere with your FMLA rights** or threaten or punish you for exercising your rights under the law. For example, your employer cannot retaliate against you for requesting FMLA leave or cooperating with a WHD investigation.

After becoming aware that your need for leave is for a reason that may qualify under the FMLA, your employer **must confirm whether you are eligible** or not eligible for FMLA leave. If your employer determines that you are eligible, your employer **must notify you in writing**:

- About your FMLA rights and responsibilities, and
- How much of your requested leave, if any, will be FMLA-protected leave.

Where can I find more information?

Call 1-866-487-9243 or visit dol.gov/fmla to learn more.

If you believe your rights under the FMLA have been violated, you may file a complaint with WHD or file a private lawsuit against your employer in court. **Scan the QR code to learn about our WHD complaint process.**



WAGE AND HOUR DIVISION
UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

Leave of Absence Guide

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Overview

The Company recognizes that due to illness, injury, and/or medical condition employees may need to be absent from their jobs for extended periods of time and/or anticipated intervals or may need special accommodations to perform their job duties. In recognition of these needs and in compliance with applicable federal, state and local law, the company has established the following types of employee leaves of absence and associated benefits:

- Family and Medical leave (FMLA) and Related State and Local Laws
- Centene Medical Leave of Absence
- Leave under Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) Accommodation
- Military Leave
- Caregiver Leave
- Personal Leave (Not covered. Please refer to CNET LOA resources)
- Short and Long-Term Disability Benefits (STD & LTD)

To best support your leave of absence or accommodation request, please read carefully through the details below outlining what to expect, your role in this process, the support you will receive and FAQs (some specific for your maternity leave) to keep you informed. At any point should you have questions regarding your leave, please contact *Lincoln Financial* at 1 800 213 7649; or Centene@lfg.com.

Throughout the process, it is essential that you proactively keep both your People Leader and Ask HR informed of the status of your leave. This will help ensure your leave is processed timely, pay and benefits are cared for as appropriate, and the business is aware of your time off.

Initiating Your Request

It is your responsibility to initiate your leave of absence or accommodation request. *If you fail to initiate your leave request or do not provide the required information timely, any days missed may be considered as unexcused absences. Please follow the steps below:*

- 1) Please call 1 800 213 7649, to initiate your request for a leave of absence or accommodation as soon as you are aware of the need. You will want to ensure you provide Lincoln Financial (LFG) with your last day worked and your first day of leave (first full day not worked due to the reason for the leave request) to ensure your absence is administered appropriately.
- 2) Upon calling *Lincoln Financial(LFG)* to initiate your request, you will receive a packet of information regarding your leave and the details required from your healthcare provider.
 - a. This information will come from LFG, our third-party leave, disability, and accommodation administrator.
 - b. LFG will require information from your healthcare provider regarding your condition to evaluate your leave and benefits.
 - c. It is your responsibility to ensure all necessary paperwork, including that of your healthcare provider, is submitted on time and is thorough, enabling LFG to fully review your need for leave/accommodation.

Important: Please submit your paperwork to LFG in the timeframe given to you. If you fail to submit the information requested by LFG by the deadline, your request for leave and/or benefits may be denied, and your job may not be protected.

- 3) Tell us how to contact you while out on a leave of absence as your system access including your work email will be disabled.

- a. Please ensure that your personal phone number and email address in our HR System, Workday, is accurate. You can update this via Workday in your employee profile. If your personal contact information changes while on leave, please contact Ask HR by calling 1-833-GoAskHR to update on your behalf.

While Out on Leave

Please see below important considerations and your required actions:

- 1) Please provide timely updates of any changes to your leave or accommodation status by calling 1 800 213 7649, or emailing your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com.
 - a. If at any point the length of your leave changes or your accommodation needs to modify, it is important we know as soon as possible.
- 2) It is your responsibility to keep your People Leader informed of any changes to your leave of absence or accommodation requests. *You do not need to inform your People of the underlying disability that gave rise to your request.*
- 3) From time to time, we may need to reach you regarding your leave request. If you receive a call from LFG or from someone within Centene, please respond at your earliest convenience and at least within 24 hours. Your timely response will help ensure we provide you important information timely and indicates that you remain interested in continued employment with Centene.

Important: To extend your leave or modify your accommodation request, you must call 1 800 213 7649, or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com. Additional paperwork and approvals are required.

- 4) Benefit deductions: You will be responsible for making bi-weekly payments for your portion of benefit premiums directly to Optum Financial, our third-party benefits administrator, for the duration of your leave.
 - a. You will receive an invoice bi-weekly to your home address from Optum Financial.
 - b. It is your responsibility to verify your home address is accurate in Workday prior to your leave of absence to ensure the invoices are mailed to the proper address.
 - c. If you do not receive an invoice from Optum Financial at any time during your LOA, it is your responsibility to contact them at 855-687-2021.
 - d. If premiums are not paid by the invoice due date, benefits may be canceled, and you will be offered COBRA coverage. Benefits will be reinstated when you return to work in a full-time status.

Important: Failure to make payment to Optum Financial by the invoice due date will result in termination of your benefits, dating back to the last invoice due date that payment was made. In some cases, if Centene is unable to cancel coverage prior to your return to work, you will be responsible for missed benefit premiums. Missed premiums will be taken from your paychecks, in the form of double deductions until all premiums are paid in full. For questions regarding benefit premiums while on LOA, please contact Optum Financial at 855-687-2021.

Returning to Work

*We want to make your return to work as smooth as possible. To ensure an easy transition, please provide **at least three (3) business days' notice** of your date of return by following the steps below:*

- 1) **Return Date:** when your return-to-work date is confirmed, please call 1 800 213 7649 or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com, within at least 3 business days to notify us of your intent to return to work. It's important that you also notify your People Leader of your return-to-work date.

- a. We require at least 3 business days to ensure that your e-mail, system access and badge access are restored, and your pay and benefits are cared for prior to your return date.
- 2) **Request for Accommodation(s):** Should you require any accommodation(s) upon your return, please make us aware as soon as possible.
 - a. Visit LFG online at <https://www.lincolfinancial.com>. (first-time users will need to input **Company Code: Centene**).
 - b. You will be required to complete appropriate paperwork to review your request.
 - c. Once your request has been initiated, please notify your People Leader that you have requested an accommodation. You do not need to inform your People Leader of the underlying disability that gave rise to your request.

If you are not able to go online to initiate your request with LFG, contact 1 800 213 7649 or send an email to Centene@lfg.com.

Important: If you do not return to work at the end of your approved leave and/or fail to submit the required information to support the need for additional time off, any days missed may be considered as unexcused absences. This may lead to discipline up to and including loss of employment.

Leave of Absence Process Overview

Centene's goal is to make this process as simple as possible and to provide answers to your questions that may arise along the way. If you have questions regarding our leave at any time during this process, please call Lincoln Financial Group (LFG) at 1-800-213-7649. For Centene policy questions please call the contact center at 1-833-GoAskHR and they will be happy to assist you. Please see the appendix of this letter for a listing of *frequently asked questions* to further assist.

Step	Task	When	Who	How
1	Contact Lincoln Financial (LFG) to initiate leave	Immediately following the discussion with People Leader	Employee	Call 1-800-213-7649 or LFG Online: https://www.lincolfinancial.com
2	Paperwork Processing	Immediately following submission of leave	Employee	a. Employee receives required paperwork for request. b. Employee returns paperwork in required timeframe.
3	Approval/Denial	Immediately following determination of leave with LFG	Employee & People Leader	Employee and People Leader receives approval/denial of leave request.
4	Return to Work	Immediately upon need	Employee	a. Call 1-800-231-7649, or LFG Online: https://www.lincolfinancial.com b. Inform People Leader of return-to-work date.
The employee is expected to keep Lincoln Financial informed and provide timely and routine updates to their People Leader of any changes. Failure to follow the process and keep your People Leader informed may result in unexcused absences and the employee may be subject to discipline.				

Intermittent Leave Process

An *intermittent leave* is protected time off taken in blocks of time rather than one continuous period, such as taking two days off per month or half days as directed by a physician.

In addition to the guidance on the [Leave of Absence and Disability Pay page](#) on Life & Career, here are the steps the employee must complete for an intermittent leave:

Intermittent Leave Process Overview:

To initiate an intermittent leave or report time missed, employees must contact Lincoln Financial Group within **five (5) business days** from the reported absence or up to 30 calendar days in advance.

Step	Task	When	Who	How
1	Contact Lincoln Financial (LFG) to initiate leave, or report time missed	Immediately following the discussion with People Leader	Employee	Call LFG at 1 800 213 7649, or Online: https://www.lincolffinancial.com Company Code: Centene AND inform People Leader of intermittent leave per department guidelines
2	Notification sent to advise of approval; or time reported	Approval - after decision is made on the claim; Reported Time - the day after time is reported to LFG	Employee/People Leader	Email from LFG
3	Manage timecard appropriately for days missed	Immediately following intermittent absence	Employee/People Leader	Enter accruals to cover time missed. Please refer to Max for assistance with editing timecard if needed, and FAQs regarding what accruals should be used.
4	Keep People Leader, and LFG updated on any extensions, changes to frequency and/or duration of the employees leave	Immediately upon need	Employee	Call LFG at 1 800 213 7649, or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com AND inform People Leader of intermittent leave per department guidelines

(Recertification may be requested) Throughout the process, it is essential that the employee is proactively keeping both their People Leader and Lincoln Financial (our third-party administrator) informed of the status the employees leave. This will help ensure the employees leave is processed timely, pay and benefits are cared for as appropriate, and the business is aware of the employee's time off.

Below is an index for all questions within this document. Please either click on the link to bring you to a specific question of interest or scroll through the document in its entirety.

Should you need clarity on the topics below or did not find an answer you were looking for please contact Ask HR at 1-833-GoAskHR, prompt 3 or reach us via Request Central under Human Resources.

General Leave of Absence FAQs

1. [When do I request a Claim/Leave \(Exception: Personal Leave\)?](#)
2. [When do I request an Accommodation?](#)
3. [Who is Lincoln Financial \(LFG\) and what role do they play?](#)
4. [How do I know if I'm eligible for a leave of absence?](#)
5. [What is the difference between FMLA, Centene Medical Leave \(CML\), Workplace Accommodation \(WA\), Caregiver Leave \(CGL\), and Short-Term Disability \(STD\)?](#)
6. [What is the difference between a continuous leave of absence, intermittent leave of absence, and reduced schedule leave of absence?](#)
7. [How are Short Term Disability \(STD\) benefits paid?](#)
8. [What is the elimination period for Short-Term Disability \(STD\) claims?](#)
9. [What is the difference between Short-Term Disability \(STD\) benefits and Long-Term Disability \(LTD\) benefits?](#)
10. [Will I accrue Vacation/PTO time while I am out on a leave of absence?](#)
11. [Who will update my timecard while on a leave of absence?](#)
12. [What happens to my benefits while I am out on leave?](#)
13. [What do I do if my leave dates change \(i.e., my leave needs to be extended or I plan to come back to work sooner\)?](#)
14. [What is the return-to-work process?](#)
15. [Do I need to file a leave/claim with LFG if I have enough Sick, Vacation/PTO time to cover my absence?](#)
16. [How do I apply for Long-Term Disability?](#)
17. [What happens if I have a qualified life event \(birth of baby, spouse loses coverage elsewhere, etc.\) while on leave?](#)

Intermittent Leave FAQs

1. [What is an intermittent leave?](#)
2. [Who do I need to report my intermittent absences to?](#)
3. [How far in advance do I need to report my intermittent absences?](#)
4. [Who will update my timecard while on an intermittent leave of absence?](#)

5. [Do I have to use my Vacation/PTO/Sick time for the time that I am out on an intermittent leave?](#)
6. [Can I borrow Vacation time/PTO while out on an intermittent leave?](#)
7. [Can I make up the time I missed for my intermittent leave?](#)
8. [Should I report my time even if my intermittent leave is currently in a pending status?](#)
9. [Will recertification of my intermittent leave be requested?](#)

State Specific FAQs

1. [What state leave programs are available to me and where can I go to learn more about them?](#)

Caregiver Leave FAQs

1. [What qualifies as an eligible event for paid Caregiver Leave?](#)
2. [Who is defined as a family member?](#)
3. [Is Caregiver Leave granted per event or an annual allotment?](#)
4. [FMLA provides 12 weeks of job protection. Can I extend my leave and use the Caregiver Leave after FMLA runs out?](#)
5. [Can I return to work intermittently while on Caregiver Leave?](#)
6. [Will my benefits continue while on Caregiver Leave?](#)

Military Leave FAQs

1. [Am I eligible for pay while on military leave?](#)

Maternity Leave FAQs

1. [How much time am I eligible to take for maternity leave?](#)
2. [What type of pay am I eligible for while I am out on a maternity leave?](#)
3. [How do I reserve a Lactation Room when I return?](#)
4. [What resources are available to assist me through the leave process?](#)

1. When do I request a Claim/Leave?

You may report a claim/leave up to 30 days in advance of a planned absence or as soon as it's foreseeable. For maternity leaves, if you stop working prior to delivering, please ensure both your People Leader and LFG are updated. LFG may need to request additional information to support any time off from work prior to your delivery.

2. When do I request an Accommodation?

Should you require any accommodation(s) please visit LFG online at <https://www.lincolfinancial.com>. (first-time users will need to input Company Code: Centene).

Once your request has been initiated, please notify your People Leader that you have requested an accommodation. You do not need to inform your People Leader of the underlying disability that gave rise to your request. If you are not able to go online to initiate your request with LFG, contact 1 800 213 7649.

3. Who is Lincoln Financial (LFG) and what role do they play?

LFG is our third-party leave, disability, and accommodation administrator. We work closely with LFG to ensure your leave request is reviewed timely and thoroughly, that all proper documentation is cared for, and you and the business are informed of appropriate next steps.

- a. You will receive notifications from LFG via email and mail and they may attempt to reach you by phone throughout your leave.
- b. Please submit your paperwork to LFG in the timeframe given to you. If you fail to submit the information requested by LFG by the deadline, your request for leave and/or benefits may be denied, and your job may not be protected.
- c. If you receive a phone call from LFG, please be sure to return this call within 24 hours.
- d. If you have any questions, please contact LFG at 1 800 213 7649, or email them at Centene@lfg.com.

4. How do I know if I'm eligible for a leave of absence?

- a. When you request a leave of absence, LFG will determine your eligibility for the various leaves of absence. One or more may apply and when multiple leaves apply, they will run concurrently with one another.
- b. FMLA leave requires that you have worked for the Company for at least one year and at least 1250 hours in the past year.
- c. Centene's Medical Leave is available after your first date of employment.
- d. Caregiver leave may be available on the first of the month after 90 days of employment.
- e. Short-Term Disability benefits may be available on the first of the month after 90 days of employment.

To confirm your eligibility, please call LFG at 1 800 213 7649.

5. What is the difference between FMLA, Centene Medical Leave, ADA, Caregiver Leave, and Short-Term Disability (STD)?

Family Medical Leave Act (FMLA) provides job protection for up to 12 workweeks of leave in a rolling 12-month period.

Centene Medical Leave of Absence is an unpaid leave that may only be used by an employee to take leave for their own serious health condition. Employees may be approved for no more than 26 workweeks within a rolling 12-month period.

Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) is a law that requires employers to provide reasonable accommodation(s) to qualified disabled employees to assist them in performing the essential functions of their jobs. Accommodations may include such things as equipment modification, job restructuring, and flexible schedules. In some cases, an employee who is not eligible for or has exhausted available leaves of absence, such as FMLA or Centene Medical Leave, may be eligible for a leave or extension of leave under the ADA.

Caregiver Leave (CGL) is a leave of absence and Centene paid benefit that can be used to bond with a child due to birth or adoption within one (1) year from the date of birth or placement or to care for an immediate family member with a serious health condition.

Short-Term Disability (STD) is the income replacement portion (100% for maternity claims, 60% for all other illness) of a leave of absence. STD approval does not guarantee leave of absence approval. Therefore, in order to have job protection, you must request a leave under the FMLA, Centene Medical Leave, or ADA *and* apply for STD as a separate benefit.

FMLA, Centene Medical Leave, ADA, Caregiver Leave, and STD are all supported by our third-party administrator, LFG. Updates on the status and approvals/denials of your requests will be shared with you to keep you informed. All run concurrently with one another when applicable.

6. What is the difference between a continuous leave of absence, intermittent leave of absence, and reduced schedule leave of absence?

A continuous leave is when an employee needs days off consecutively due to serious health condition of their own or an eligible family member.

An intermittent leave is taken in blocks of time rather than one continuous period, such as taking two days off per month as directed by a physician.

A reduced schedule leave reduces an employee's normal number of working hours per workweek or per workday such as an employee who normally works 40 hours per week and is only able to work 30 hours per week or four hours per day for a specified duration.

7. How are Short-Term Disability (STD) benefits paid?

Disability benefits are the income replacement portion of a leave of absence. STD approval does not guarantee leave of absence approval. Therefore, in order to have job protection, you must request a leave under the FMLA, Centene Medical Leave, or ADA *and* apply for STD as a separate benefit.

- a. Once LFG has reviewed the claim and it has been determined to be compensable, they will begin to send STD paychecks directly to your home on a weekly basis. You can also request direct deposit.
- b. For maternity claims, STD benefits are 100% of basic weekly earnings less other income benefits and other income earnings.
- c. For all other disability claims, STD benefits are 60% of basic weekly earnings less other income benefits and other income earnings.
- d. Regular full-time employees are eligible for STD pay the first of the month after they have been employed at Centene for 90 days.
- e. FICA is withheld for the first six (6) months following the employee's last day worked. Federal and State income taxes will automatically be withheld at a rate of "single". If employees desire additional Federal and State tax withholdings, they can send LFG a W4/W4-S Form.

****STD benefits will be offset by any state benefits for which you may be eligible.**

8. What is the elimination period for Short-Term Disability claims?

There is a one-week elimination period for all STD claims. The elimination period must be completely unworked. If you return to work for any amount of time during this period, the elimination period will start over. Paid time off must be used during the elimination period.

- a. Sick time will be used first before PTO/Vacation when coding time.
- b. If the employee does not have any available Sick, or PTO/Vacation accruals to use, the elimination period will be unpaid.
- c. The elimination period does count toward the total disability period prescribed by the physician (example: If you are approved for 6 weeks of disability pay, you will only receive 5 weeks of STD since the first week is the elimination period).
- d. Employees are not allowed to take paid time off in lieu of filing a disability claim.

9. What is the difference between Short-Term Disability benefits and Long-Term Disability benefits?

Centene provides Short-Term Disability (STD) and Long-Term Disability (LTD) insurance at no cost to you. Some employees choose to pay their own LTD premiums so they can receive the benefit tax-free.

	Short-Term Disability*	Long-Term Disability
Benefit	60% of base monthly earnings 100% of base monthly earnings for maternity	60% of base monthly earnings
Maximum Benefit	None	\$11,000/month
Elimination Period	7 calendar days, accident, illness, or maternity	180 calendar days
Benefit Duration	Up to 26 weeks	Social Security normal age (Visit http://www.ssa.gov)
Premium Option	Company paid only	Company paid or employee paid
<i>*New hires are eligible the first of the month after 90 days of employment</i>		

10. Will I accrue Vacation/PTO time while I am out on a leave of absence?

Vacation/PTO time will not continue to accrue per payroll period when an employee is not working and is receiving STD or Caregiver Leave payments.

- a. Once regular Centene paychecks are reinstated, either because you are being paid Sick and/or accrued Vacation/PTO time or have returned to work, you will earn an accrual.
- b. The best rule of thumb is if you are getting paid from Centene, there is an accrual; if you are getting paid through Short-Term Disability or Caregiver Leave, there is no accrual.

11. Who will update my timecard while on a leave of absence?

Continuous Leave: The Absence Management Team (AMT) manages timecards for all employees on a continuous leave of absence in accordance with the type of leave you are on and company policy. Due to this, please do not update your timecard or have your People Leader update your timecard. This will ensure you are paid correctly and will avoid an overpayment or underpayment.

Intermittent and Reduced Scheduled Leave: Please see the Intermittent Leave section for further details.

12. What happens to my benefits while I am out on leave?

You will be responsible for making bi-weekly payments for your portion of benefit premiums directly to Optum Financial, our third-party administrator.

- a. If on a continuous or reduced work schedule leave of absence, you will receive an invoice bi-weekly at your home address from Optum Financial.
- b. Failure to make payment to Optum Financial by the invoice due date may result in termination of your benefits, dating back to the last invoice due date that payment was made. In some cases, if Centene is unable to cancel coverage prior to your return to work, you will be responsible for missed benefit

premiums. Missed premiums will be taken from your paychecks when you return to work, in the form of double deductions until all premiums are paid in full. For questions regarding benefit premiums while on LOA, please contact Optum Financial at 855-687-2021. If benefits are terminated due to non-payment of premiums, you will be offered COBRA coverage. Benefits will be reinstated when you return to work in a full-time status.

- c. If you do not receive an invoice by mail while on leave or have misplaced it, it is your responsibility to contact Optum Financial to request a new invoice or make payment.
- d. Please make sure your home address is accurate in Workday before you go on leave. If your address changes while on leave, please contact Ask HR by calling 1-833-GoAskHR to update on your behalf.

13. What do I do if my leave dates change (i.e., my leave needs to be extended or I plan to come back to work sooner)?

- a. Should there be a change in your leave dates, you must call 1 800 213 7649 to keep LFG updated on any changes to the status or duration of your leave of absence.
- b. In addition, you should also notify your People Leader of any changes to your leave dates.
- c. If you request to adjust the dates of your leave, additional medical documentation will be requested to substantiate the changes. Failure to timely provide this information to LFG may result in the denial or closure of the leave request.

14. What is the Return-to-Work process?

- a. You must communicate your return-to-work date **at least three (3) business days** in advance of the return by calling 1 800 213 7649 or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com. Failure to do so will result in a delay of your system access restoration.
- b. You must also notify your People Leader in the same timeframe.
- c. If anything changes, you should contact your People Leader as soon as possible and LFG by calling 1 800 213 7649, or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com.
- d. If additional time off is being requested, you must notify your People Leader to advise and contact LFG by calling 1 800 213 7649, or email your LFG case manager at Centene@lfg.com to request additional leave.

15. Do I need to file a leave/claim with LFG if I have enough Sick, Vacation/PTO time to cover my absence?

Yes, per our Leave of Absence Policy, you must request a leave of absence for reasons covered by the leave of absence policy for absences in excess of five business days. Also, you may not elect to use Vacation/PTO/Sick time in lieu of receiving disability benefits.

16. How do I apply for Long-Term Disability?

Long-Term Disability pay is a benefit offered by Centene after your STD benefit is exhausted. If your disability is going to last longer than 180 calendar days, the claim is automatically reviewed by LFG's Long-Term Disability department as long as the STD claim is active and approved. You will receive an application for Long-Term Disability via mail. If approved, Long-Term Disability checks are mailed to your home address monthly. You can also request direct deposit. Long-Term Disability benefits are 60% of base monthly earnings not to exceed a maximum monthly benefit of \$11,000 less other income benefits and other income earnings.

17. What happens if I have a qualified life event (birth of baby, spouse loses coverage elsewhere, etc.) while on leave?

You can update your benefit elections due to your qualifying life event by visiting [BenefitConnect](#).

- a. Log in to [BenefitConnect](#)
- b. Click "First time user? Create an account".

- c. If you do not have access to your work email, answer "No" to "Do you know your email?" to proceed with creating your account. During the registration process, use a non-work email address since a verification code will be sent to that email address.
- d. Once you successfully register and select "Login", click "Update My Benefits Due To A Qualifying Event" to start your enrollment.
- e. Contact **Ask HR at 1-833-GoAskHR** and select the **Benefits** prompt if you need help registering or enrolling.

Please note, you must update your elections within 31 days of a baby's birth or the qualifying event in order for the event to be approved. When adding a newborn to coverage, you have 60 days from the date of birth to provide a birth certificate. All other qualifying life events require proper documentation to be uploaded within 31 days of your qualifying event in order for the new elections to be approved. If you miss these deadlines, you must wait until the next Annual Enrollment period in order to make changes to your benefits.

Intermittent Leave FAQs

1. What is an intermittent leave?

An *intermittent leave* is taken in blocks of time rather than one continuous period, such as taking two days off per month as directed by a physician.

2. Who do I need to report my intermittent absences to?

- a. Your People Leader
- b. LFG within 5 business days of missing the time from work by calling 1 800 213 7649, or via email at Centene@lfg.com.
- c. If intermittent leave time is not reported to LFG within 5 business days, the time missed may be considered as unexcused absences. This may lead to discipline up to and including loss of employment.

3. How far in advance do I need to report my intermittent absences?

If the need for leave is foreseeable, employees should report their intermittent time up to 30 calendar days in advance. For unplanned absences, you must report intermittent leave within **5 business days** of the time missed. If you already have an approved intermittent leave, when reporting intermittent time, please provide your Intermittent Claim Number.

4. Who will update my timecard while on an intermittent leave of absence?

You are responsible for coding your timecard. Any hours worked should be coded as worked hours and hours not worked should be coded with any available Sick or Vacation/PTO (exhaust sick time, then vacation/PTO). For non-exempt employees who have exhausted their available time, hours should be coded as unpaid hours.

Note: If you are approved for Partial Disability or intermittent Paid Family Leave (PFL) in California, Colorado, Connecticut, Massachusetts, New Jersey, New York, Oregon, Rhode Island, or Washington, hours not worked should be coded as unpaid hours on your timecard. This is because the hours not worked are eligible for pay through state benefits under PFL and/or Caregiver Leave benefits through LFG, not through Centene payroll. You cannot choose to supplement PFL benefits with Sick and/or Vacation/PTO to receive 100% pay.

5. Do I have to use my Vacation/PTO/Sick time for the time that I am out on an intermittent leave?

Yes, employees are expected to enter available Sick or Vacation/PTO time into the myPay by Dayforce timekeeping system to be paid for hours not worked due to intermittent leave. Exempt and non-exempt employees may record time in fifteen-minute increments in myPay by Dayforce for the purposes of being paid.

6. Can I borrow vacation time/PTO while out on an intermittent leave?

Yes, at the discretion of the employee's People Leader, vacation/PTO time may be taken before it is accrued:

- a. Full-time employees may borrow (go negative) up to 40 hours at a time.
- b. Part-time employees may borrow (go negative) up to 16 hours at a time.

Note: Any borrowed vacation/PTO time will be paid back with future payroll accruals and is to be paid back in full by the end of the calendar year in which it is taken. Employees cannot have a negative balance on 12/31.

7. Can I make up the time I missed for my intermittent leave?

Make up time is not allowed; employees must use their available accruals for time missed due to their intermittent leave. If they do not have any remaining accruals, the time will be unpaid.

8. Should I report my time even if my intermittent leave is currently in a pending status?

Yes, employees should report absences that occur while their intermittent leave is in pending status to Lincoln Financial and People Leader within 5 business days.

9. Will recertification of my intermittent leave be requested?

We understand that medical needs may evolve over time. Due to this, intermittent leave requests will need to be recertified with your physician every 6 months to confirm if your leave needs have changed.

State Specific FAQs

1. What state leave programs are available to me and where can I go to learn more about them?

Please contact your state disability program directly or visit their webpage to learn more about those programs. State disability benefits will offset STD benefits through Centene.

- California: edd.ca.gov
- Colorado: <https://famli.colorado.gov/>
- Connecticut: ctpaidleave.org
- Hawaii: hawaii.gov/labor/dcd/abouttdi.shtml
- Massachusetts: <https://www.mass.gov/topics/paid-family-and-medical-leave-in-massachusetts>
- New Jersey: lwd.dol.state.nj.us
- New York: www.wcb.ny.gov
 - Click on Worker's link then review the Disability Benefits box
- Oregon: <https://paidleave.oregon.gov/>
- Rhode Island: <http://www.dlt.ri.gov/tid/>
- Washington: <https://www.paidleave.wa.gov/>

2. How do state benefits affect benefits through Lincoln Financial?

All state benefits will offset payments from Lincoln Financial for STD, LTD, and CGL benefits. For example, Centene's STD benefit for most illnesses will be paid out at 60% of base monthly earnings. If a state benefit is paying 50% of your base monthly earnings, this will offset STD benefits through LFG and your STD benefit will be the remaining 10% to get your total to 60% with the two benefits combined.

Caregiver Leave FAQs

1. What qualifies as an eligible event for paid Caregiver Leave?

- a. Newborn/Adoption; for bonding with a newborn or newly adopted child (includes foster children effective 1/1/2024)
- b. Family Care; the care of a spouse, domestic partner, child or parent of the employee if the family member has a serious health condition.

2. Who is defined as a family member?

Eligible family members include one's spouse, domestic partner, child up to age 18 (includes foster children effective 1/1/2024) and parents.

3. Is Caregiver Leave granted per event or an annual allotment?

It is an annual allotment. Employees are eligible for up to six weeks in a rolling calendar year for eligible events on a combined basis.

4. FMLA provides 12 weeks of job protection. Can I extend my leave and use the Caregiver Leave after FMLA runs out?

No. Because Caregiver Leave runs concurrently with FMLA or other state leaves, the six weeks of Caregiver Leave must be used during the same time your position is protected by FMLA.

5. Can I return to work intermittently while on Caregiver Leave?

No, Caregiver Leave is to be taken as a continuous, full time leave only, in 1-6 week increments. Employees cannot take time off under this benefit in less than one full week increment, such as a day at a time.

6. Will my benefits continue while on Caregiver Leave?

Yes, benefits you were enrolled in prior to a Caregiver Leave will continue for the duration of your leave. If Caregiver Leave is used for longer than 1 weeks at a time, the employee will be billed by Optum Financial for the duration of the leave.

7. How are Caregiver Leave benefits paid?

- a. Once LFG has received your leave and it has been determined to be compensable, they will begin to send Caregiver Leave paychecks directly to your home on a weekly basis. You can also request direct deposit.
- b. Caregiver Leave benefits are 100% of basic weekly earnings, less other income earnings such as State benefits (ex: Paid Family Leave).

Military Leave FAQs

1. Am I eligible for pay while on military leave?

Yes, Centene will pay the difference between an eligible employee's military pay and the employee's regular rate of pay at Centene for a period of up to 26 weeks per leave, not to exceed 26 weeks in any rolling 12-month period. You must contact LFG, Centene's leave administrator, and submit a copy of your Leave and Earnings Statement (LES) in order to request payment.

Maternity Leave FAQs

1. How much time am I eligible to take for maternity leave?

If you are FMLA eligible (have worked at Centene for 12+ months and worked at least 1250 hours in the past year) you are eligible for 12 weeks of FMLA protection which includes: 8 weeks to recover from having the baby and 6 additional weeks to bond with your baby. If your child is born on or after January 1, 2023, the enhanced Caregiver Leave benefit will allow two (2) additional weeks of bonding time.

The first 8 weeks of that leave you may be eligible for Short Term Disability (STD) benefits. In most situations, including having a C-section, time taken after 8 weeks is not eligible for STD pay.

Under certain state leave laws, you may be eligible to take more than 12 weeks off work. LFG will be able to confirm any additional leave time you may be eligible to take.

Caregiver Leave benefits will run concurrently with any Federal or State leave laws and will not extend the amount of leave available under these laws. You cannot choose to use Caregiver Leave benefits after Federal and State leave exhausts to take additional time off.

If you have taken some FMLA time within the last 12 months, you will not have 12 full weeks of protected time available. Please call LFG to see how much time you have available by calling 1 800 213 7649.

2. What type of pay am I eligible for while I am out on a maternity leave?

If you are full time and have been employed with Centene long enough to qualify for Short-Term Disability (STD) when your leave begins, we will record Sick/Vacation/PTO time for the 5-business day waiting period before STD starts.

- One (1) week Sick/Vacation/PTO – paid by Centene
- Seven (7) weeks of STD
- Caregiver Leave up to 6 weeks (in one week increments or continuously)
- After STD pay and Caregiver Leave benefits end, remaining Sick/Vacation/PTO until exhausted – paid by Centene
- If your leave carries over to a new year and you are not eligible or have exhausted your STD pay, your new year's Sick time allocation will be used.

If you are not eligible for STD, we will record all available Sick/Vacation/PTO until it is exhausted.

Employees at Director level and above who have no set allotment of Vacation/PTO or Sick time will be paid the following when on maternity leave:

- Week 1: 100%
- Weeks 2-8: STD – 100%
- Weeks 9-12+: Caregiver Leave – 100%

3. How do I reserve a Lactation Room when I return?

In large offices there are dedicated spaces that serve as Lactation Rooms, but they do not have a standard location. In smaller offices the requirement for this space may be met by dual purposing another appropriate room, i.e., conference room, office or other private room. Please refer to the Lactation Rooms Procedure in [Archer](#) (CC.FACL.30) for information and guidance on locating and reserving a room. For questions or assistance regarding the room reservation process, please contact Facilities@Centene.com.

4. What resources are available to assist me through the maternity leave process?

BenefitBump is a benefit navigation solution for all growing families with support for pregnancy, adoption, and fertility treatment. Participants are assigned a dedicated Care Navigator to guide them through the BenefitBump program and their entire parenthood journey. BenefitBump helps you optimize your Centene-provided benefits, improve your well-being, and reduce stress along your parenthood journey. You can reach out to BenefitBump at participantservices@benefitbump.com or call 888-2867314 for questions about the program. If you are ready to sign up, you can register at mybenefitbump.com (invitation code: Centene).

Additional Information

For questions, chat with our virtual assistant Max, submit an HR request through [Request Central](#), or contact AskHR at 1-833-Go-Ask-HR.